Known, Guessed or Missing?

Thirteen quick questions about what your family knows before asking about Medicaid. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and nothing here says whether she may qualify for Medicaid.

1. Have you written down what your family has been told about Medicaid so far, and who said each thing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Has anyone explained what “too much money” or “spend down” would mean in Mom's state and situation?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which Medicaid program in Mom's state goes with the kind of care she's getting?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you have anything in writing from the hospital, the rehab or the facility about the care Mom needs now?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you have the papers that show where Mom lives and her citizenship or immigration status?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Is Mom's monthly income written down, with a paper behind each amount?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you have a written list of what Mom owns, with a recent statement or document for each item?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you written down whether Mom is married and, if she is, where her spouse is living?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Do you know whether Mom owns a home and, if she does, whose name is on the deed?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Do you know whose name is on each of Mom's accounts, including any she holds with someone else?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Have you written down any gifts, transfers or changes in ownership the family remembers, with rough dates?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Do you know whether Mom has a trust, an annuity or life insurance, and do you have the paperwork for each?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

13. For each open question, do you know who you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not what Mom has or where she stands. A low count means there are things still to find or ask, and most of them are a drawer, a phone call or a family conversation away. It doesn't add anything up, compare anything with a limit, or say what any answer means for Medicaid. Rules vary by state, nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice, and those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what you know, what you've only been told and what's still missing. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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